



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Christus Classical School

School Website: <https://www.christusclassicalschool.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Christus Classical School (Carthage, MO, 64836) presents a public-facing program that aligns strongly with classical Christian schooling norms. Text from the school's materials repeatedly emphasizes reading classic books, embracing the seven liberal arts, and forming virtue within a biblical framework. The school foregrounds truth, goodness, and beauty as transcendent aims, and it anchors education in Scripture, covenantal commitment, and parental partnership. Taken together, these signals map primarily to CLASSICAL across the six rubric categories, with some elements that are less fully developed in public materials (notably some explicit pedagogy signals like Socratic seminars and a broader "liturgical" or communal worship practice). Absolute religious language is present, but the school also notes non-denominational alignment and covenantal aims, which creates a nuanced posture around theology and community.

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Notable strengths: explicit commitment to the seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books / Great Conversation framing, formation of virtue, Scripture-centered worldview, and strong parental partnership signals.
- Potential needle-moving gaps (for a fully classical pedagogy portrayal): explicit articulation of high-school Socratic seminars or deliberative seminars, more explicit liturgical or communal worship practices in line with classical liturgy signals, and clearer living-curriculum signals tied to a broader faculty development narrative.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's public materials frame education through Scripture and a biblically oriented worldview: "the foundational truths of the Holy Bible," "the Word of God is sufficient and supreme for faith and practice," and "Canon of Scripture" as a guiding authority. This language appears in multiple posts and pages, including mentions of Scripture-centric identity and theological framing. - The school identifies itself as classical and Christian, with explicit references to a covenantal framework and to teaching from a biblical worldview. - The school emphasizes "truth, goodness, and beauty" as core transcendentals woven through curriculum and life (a hallmark of the transcendental-based classical rubric).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; Word of God; Canon of Scripture; theology; covenantal; sacred tradition (present in curriculum orientation and worldview statements). Estimated positive keyword presence: high (multiple explicit uses across separate pages). - Negative keywords observed: references to being non-denominational or not affiliated with a single church (potential signaling of a broad theological stance rather than a narrowly defined liturgical practice). This is a mixed signal within a strongly biblical framing.

Why this rating - The public materials consistently foreground theological grounding, Scripture, and a classical-tradition approach, aligning with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations signals in the Six Essentials rubric. The explicit mention of the Word of God, Canon of Scripture, and a covenantal Christian framing strongly anchors this category as CLASSICAL, with the nuance that a non-denominational alignment is mentioned, which slightly broadens the theological posture but does not overshadow the explicit biblical, transcendentals-based framing.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Language emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom, not mere vocational outcomes: “cultivation of wisdom and virtue,” “formation,” and a biblically grounded telos. The school frames education as forming character in service to God and neighbor, rather than primarily job preparation. - The school states goals around truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, with an aim toward human flourishing and moral imagination. - The Great Books/Great Conversation framing is presented in the context of forming human excellence within Western/Christian intellectual heritage. While the exact phrase “Great Conversation” appears in the classical education lexicon, the site references engagement with “classic books” and a historical-literary framework.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, truth/goodness/beauty, classical mission, Great Books/Great Conversation signals. Estimated positive keyword presence: substantial (multiple explicit mentions across pages). - Negative keywords observed: none that strongly indicate a shift away from formation toward job-readiness or utilitarian framing. The material does not emphasize “workforce readiness” or “career preparation” as the primary aim; instead, formation and virtue are foregrounded. (No explicit negative signals found in the public materials for this category.)

Why this rating - The school's stated aims align with formation of virtue and wisdom and a pursuit of transcendental truths, consistent with CLASSICAL signals for Element 2.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described as a classical model centered on the seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), with explicit mention of studying classic books and the seven liberal arts. - The site references the use of “grammar school curriculum,” “logic school curriculum,” and “rhetoric school curriculum,” indicating a trichotomous grammar/logic/rhetoric structure. - The school references reading “classic books” and participating in “the Great Conversation” within its curriculum framing. - The site highlights cross-subject integration and wonder as pedagogical aims, aligning with classic formation through integrated study rather than isolated fact-collection.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar/logic/rhetoric); Great Books / Great Conversation; historic, integrated curriculum; formation through wonder; “read classic books.” Estimated positive keyword presence: high. - Negative keywords observed: no explicit signals of “social studies only” history-as-social-studies framing; rather, history is integrated with literature and philosophy as part of a liberal-arts approach. There is no explicit negative marker from the provided materials.

Why this rating - The explicit articulation of grammar/logic/rhetoric, seven liberal arts, Great Books/Great Conversation engagement, and integrated history/literature/philosophy signals, all align with CLASSICAL curriculum criteria per the rubric.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school principle emphasizes thinking well, logic, and rhetoric, i.e., “how to think, not what to think,” suggesting an emphasis on reasoning and classical discourse. - Pedagogical signals include the use of the liberal-arts-based trivium approach (grammar, logic, rhetoric) in the curriculum. The public materials mention “grammar, logic, rhetoric” and the seven liberal arts as part of the pedagogy. - There is an absence of explicit, publicly stated Socratic seminars, formal seminars/debates, or upper-school rhetoric seminars in the

posted materials (public pages emphasize the model and formation rather than explicit Socratic pedagogy). The Great Books/Great Conversation language is present, but explicit “Socratic seminars” or “debates” are not prominently described in the public materials available here. This signals alignment with some classical pedagogy signals but lacks explicit documentation of some higher-level classical methods (as defined in the Six Elements document).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: rhetoric, logic, grammar; “read classic books” and “the seven liberal arts”; “truth, logic, rhetoric” framing; English-language signals around persuasion and eloquence. Estimated positive keyword presence: moderate-to-high. - Negative keywords observed: lack of explicit Socratic seminars, formal seminars/debates, or “Scholé” restfulness detailed in classroom practice (though “restful learning” and contemplative elements can be inferred from the formation emphasis, explicit “scholé” pedagogy is not clearly documented). This yields a mixed signal.

Why this rating - Pedagogical signals strongly align with classical pedagogy (grammar-logic-rhetoric, Great Books, formation), but the publicly documented specifics of high-school Socratic seminars or formal upper-school rhetoric workshops are not clearly present in the accessible public materials. Hence, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL for Element 4.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Founders and leadership are named and described in ways that frame faculty as mentors and builders of a classical culture: the Head of School and founding board are highlighted; a narrative of teachers who model virtue and cultivate a love of learning appears in the materials. - Materials describe faculty as the living curriculum in other classical traditions, and the public posts place emphasis on teacher roles in forming character and academic life. The presence of “founding families” and a Head of School indicates a faculty leadership structure, but less explicit, widely-circulated narrative about faculty as mentors and “portrait of what a teacher should be” within the public site text itself. Evidence of “portrait of teacher” philosophy is present in the recruitment and leadership framing but is less explicit as a formal living-curriculum narrative in the public content. - There is mention of a “Head of School” and “founding board members,” implying a governance and mentorship framework, but not a fully articulated “living curriculum” or “faculty portrait” tradition in the public-facing materials.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: mentor/teacher as guide; “Head of School” and founders; culture of learning; “virtue,” “wisdom,” and “character formation” aspirational language. Estimated positive keyword presence: moderate. - Negative keywords observed: lack of explicit language about a formal “living curriculum” or an extended faculty-development program in the public content. This yields a neutral-to-slightly negative signal for a fully developed Faculty signal.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a classical-favorable faculty frame (leaders and founders described; mentorship-oriented language appears), but the public materials do not consistently present a fully developed “living curriculum” faculty profile or culture. Thus, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL for Element 5.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site uses explicit language about partnership with parents and the family as co-educators: “In Loco Parentis for Christian parents,” parental involvement in learning, and a program designed to engage families in the education process. - There are recurring signals toward parent engagement and formation (e.g., surveys for families, community information meetings, open houses, newsletters, and the emphasis on families partnering with the school). This is evident in posts and contact information that highlight parent involvement and church-family integration in the broader plan. - The materials reference need-based scholarships and a family-centered enrollment process, suggesting ongoing engagement with families and a community orientation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-educators; parental formation; home-school connection; open campus/visits; family engagement; community events;

shared mission. The site shows multiple signals of parent involvement and community-building. Estimated positive keyword presence: high. - Negative keywords observed: none that indicate a retreat from parental partnership; a few texts emphasize non-denominational posture, but that does not negate the parental-partnership signals. Overall, category signals are strongly positive for the parental-community dimension.

Why this rating - The public materials strongly support Element 6: Parents & Community as CLASSICAL, with explicit references to parental partnership, family involvement, and community-building signals.

Aggregate Ranking and Synthesis

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

- The school demonstrates a robust classical orientation across Religious Foundations, Purpose/Goal, Curriculum, and Parents/Community, with explicit references to the liberal arts, Great Books/Great Conversation framing, and virtue formation. Pedagogy and Faculty signals show strong classical alignment in many respects but lack explicit, consistently documented, high-level classical pedagogy specifics (e.g., frequent Socratic seminars, fully codified “living curriculum” for faculty), resulting in two categories receiving a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating. Taken together, the overall evaluation is CLASSICAL, with two practical needle-movers identified below.

What Would Move the Needle

- Pedagogy (Element 4): Publicly document and implement explicit high-school Socratic seminars and structured debates as a core pedagogical method, including a visible “Socrates/seminar” cadence in the upper grades and a public-facing description of scholé/restful/pensive days embedded in the schedule.
- Faculty (Element 5): Develop and publish a formal “living curriculum” narrative and faculty portrait language, including ongoing teacher-formation plans, mentorship models, and a documented, public-facing described model of the teacher as a core part of the living curriculum.
- Liturgical/Communal Practices (Element 1 enhancement): If desired, articulate a more explicit liturgical or communal practice framework (even within a non-denominational, covenantal Christian context) to clearly connect daily classroom life with liturgical rhythms, worship patterns, and communal rites, while preserving the non-denominational alignment. This would strengthen Element 1’s liturgical/communal signal without sacrificing the school’s stated denominational posture.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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